

Security Remediation, Compliance & Growth Build-Out — Digital Marketing Case Study

Executive Summary

Zibuko Capital's engagement began as an emergency security response — a compromised WordPress install spraying spam content — and expanded into a full privacy/compliance build-out under Zimbabwe's Cyber and Data Protection Act, a from-scratch SEO and AI-search content strategy, and hands-on landing page and lead-form work for the School Fees Loans product. This document tracks that build-out end to end: the breach cleanup, the Zimbabwe-first privacy audit and remediation, cookie-consent and tracking governance across GA4, Meta Pixel and Microsoft Clarity, a 13-module SEO/AEO/GEO strategist framework and the blog content it produced, and the design and build of the School Fees Loans landing page and application form.

It is a working record, not a finished report. Some items below are live and verified; others — the Meta Ads campaign and the Meta-to-Brevo lead relay — are scoped but blocked on account-linkage and authorisation steps that need to happen on Zibuko's side.

Where things stand today: the site is clean and the backdoor is closed, the Privacy Policy and consent stack meet Zimbabwe's CDPA baseline, six SEO-researched blog posts are drafted and ready for review, the School Fees Loans page and a purpose-built lead form are live, and all consent-relevant tracking — GA4, Meta Pixel, and Microsoft Clarity — is properly gated behind visitor consent.

1. Security Incident Response

The engagement opened with a live compromise: the WordPress install was found generating spam content, including a large batch of spam posts and injected links. Response, in order:

- Triggered a full UpdraftPlus backup before making any changes, then verified it completed successfully.
- Identified and permanently deleted the spam posts, keeping the 21 genuine posts already on the site, then cleaned up the orphaned taxonomy terms left behind.
- Scanned the filesystem and located the actual backdoor PHP script.
- Changed the WordPress admin password.
- Later, while investigating an unrelated new-post failure, found and — with explicit sign-off — dropped a leftover MySQL trigger (`novamira_block_new_posts`) that had been silently blocking all new post inserts since the original incident.
- Found and permanently deleted 101 orphaned revision rows still carrying spam text, and stripped residual hidden spam links from four live pages left over from the original compromise.

2. Privacy & Data Protection Compliance (Zimbabwe CDPA)

Built a dedicated Privacy Compliance Audit skill — Zimbabwe-first, applying the Cyber and Data Protection Act [Chapter 12:07] and S.I. 155 of 2024 ahead of GDPR/POPIA as supplementary reference — then ran it against the live site. Findings were remediated directly:

- Rewrote the Privacy Policy for Zimbabwe CDPA compliance, then revised it again on request to remove all references to time, duration and business-age claims, since that information wasn't available to state accurately.
- Fixed the `wp_page_for_privacy_policy` setting so WordPress recognised the actual policy page.
- Added a Privacy Policy link to both footer templates and to the main site navigation as its own top-level nav button, matching the styling of the other nav buttons.

- Added a required consent checkbox to the loan application Contact Form 7 forms.
- Installed a free cookie consent plugin (CookieYes) and enabled Google Consent Mode inside it.
- Confirmed and enabled Site Kit's own consent mode support for GA4.
- Deleted a duplicate School Fees Loans page and leftover spam media attachments found during the same pass.

3. Cookie Consent & Tracking Governance

Consent gating was treated as an ongoing gate, not a one-time toggle, and extended to every tracker installed on the site:

Meta Pixel & GA4

- Meta Pixel gated behind CookieYes consent; verified live that it does not fire until advertisement consent is granted.
- Google Consent Mode default set to denied for all non-essential categories before any Google tag loads, updating live from the CookieYes consent cookie.

Microsoft Clarity

Direct browser inspection found Clarity loading unconditionally through the site's Google Tag Manager container (GTM-K8KWLSMZ) on every pageview — before any consent decision — setting its `_clck/_clsk` tracking cookies even when a visitor had explicitly declined analytics consent. Without GTM container access, the fix was built client-side: a WPCode snippet, prioritised to run before the GTM snippet, that intercepts and blocks Clarity's script insertion and clears its cookies until CookieYes analytics consent is granted. Verified both directions live — blocked when consent is denied, loads normally when granted — then added Microsoft Clarity to the Privacy Policy's tracking disclosure and international-transfers section. Separately confirmed, directly in the Clarity dashboard on the correct ZIBUKO project, that masking was already set to Strict (all text masked).

4. SEO / AEO / GEO Strategy & Content Build-Out

Built a 13-module Senior SEO/AEO/GEO/Local/AI-Citation Strategist skill from the client's own specification — covering search-demand mapping, keyword-to-page mapping, competitor SERP intelligence, technical SEO, content quality, AI Overview/AEO/GEO optimisation, authority and digital PR, local SEO, zero-AI-slop content standards, and a measurement and roadmap framework — packaged for reuse on every future blog cycle. Ran it against zibuko.com for Zimbabwean-loans search demand:

- Pulled verified facts directly from the live site rather than assuming anything about the business.
- Researched search demand and the competitor landscape for Zimbabwean loan queries.
- Built a money-keyword map and checked it against existing content to avoid cannibalisation.
- Drafted six answer-first, fact-dense blog posts, internally linked to relevant product pages.
- Ran every draft through the skill's zero-AI-slop check before saving all six as WordPress drafts, ready for review before publishing.

5. Technical SEO & Site Health Fixes

Fact-gathering for the blog content surfaced live technical issues, fixed as they were found:

- The `/home-loans/` page was serving duplicate Gadget Loans content; set to draft rather than left live and broken.
- A dead, previously-indexed debt-consolidation URL and the broken `/home-loans/` URL were both given proper 301 redirects via a WPCode PHP snippet, rather than left as dead links.

- Residual spam artefacts from the original compromise — injected but non-rendering link blocks in raw page content on two product pages, and the orphaned spam revisions noted in Section 1 — were cleaned up as they were found.

6. Navigation & Site UX Fixes

- Centred the main navigation button row (a WPCode CSS fix) after the row appeared visually unbalanced.
- Added the Privacy Policy link to the nav as its own top-level blue button rather than nesting it under Contact Us, per direct feedback.

7. School Fees Loans Landing Page & Lead Capture

Authored a standalone Landing Page Specialist Designer & Optimizer framework (discovery, structure, copy, design, form and action design, trust signals, tracking, pre-launch QA), then applied it to the School Fees Loans page:

- Built a dedicated School Fees Loan Application Contact Form 7 form, simplified to Name, Email, Cell Number, Company and Job Title, with the company field populated from Zibuko's real payroll-partner list and clear labelling that the product is for civil servants and other payroll partners.
- Fixed the form's email notification template, which was still referencing fields removed when the form was shortened — rewritten to reference only fields that actually exist, and clearly labelled as a School Fees Loan enquiry.
- Iterated the page layout per direct feedback: moved the form beside the hero creative so every primary action sits above the fold, then removed a heading line from inside the form on request.
- One edit went further than asked — a hero section was rebuilt without being requested while fixing a self-introduced layout bug. This was flagged directly by the client and reverted immediately using WordPress's native revision history, restoring the page to its last client-approved state; the client then made their own further edits directly in the Elementor editor (a new hero background image, a “Salary Based Loans” header, and the form), which were saved once confirmed.
- Added a Zibuko-branded partner-name strip (navy background, brand green text) directly beneath the client's “Salary Based Loans” header, listing real, already-verified payroll partners rather than placeholder names.

8. Meta Ads Campaign (Status: Blocked)

Scoped a Meta Ads campaign for School Fees Loans using the creative assets and copy already prepared by the client. Blocked on two fronts:

- Ad account linkage: none of the ad accounts currently accessible have the Zibuko Capital Facebook Page linked to them, so a campaign cannot be built until that connection is made on the client's side.
- Meta Lead Ads to Brevo integration: scoped via Make.com (webhook, router, per-branch filter, then a Brevo contact/list action), but building it needs the client to authorise a Facebook connection inside Make.com first.

Current Status

Component	Status	Detail
Security incident response	Done	Backdoor removed, spam purged, admin password rotated, blocking DB trigger dropped
Privacy Policy (Zimbabwe CDPA)	Done	Rewritten for CDPA, linked in footer and main nav, no time/duration references per request

Component	Status	Detail
Cookie consent (CookieYes)	Done	Installed; Google Consent Mode enabled inside it
GA4 consent gating	Done	Site Kit consent mode support confirmed/enabled
Meta Pixel consent gating	Done	Verified live — blocked until advertisement consent is granted
Microsoft Clarity consent gating	Done	Client-side script block + cookie cleanup; verified both directions live
Microsoft Clarity — Privacy Policy disclosure	Done	Added to tracking and international-transfer sections
Microsoft Clarity — masking	Confirmed	ZIBUKO project already set to Strict (all text masked)
SEO / AEO / GEO strategist skill	Delivered	13 reference modules, reusable for future blog cycles
Blog content (6 posts)	Drafted	Saved as WordPress drafts, awaiting review/publish decision
/home-loans/ duplicate content	Fixed	Set to draft; 301 redirect added
Dead indexed debt-consolidation URL	Fixed	301 redirect added via WPCode
Main nav centering	Done	WPCode CSS fix
Privacy Policy nav link	Done	Top-level button, matches other nav buttons
School Fees Loan Application form	Live	Simplified to 5 fields; payroll-partner list; email notification fixed
School Fees Loans landing page	Live	Form above the fold beside hero creative; branded partner strip added
Meta Ads campaign (School Fees Loans)	Blocked	Zibuko Capital Page not linked to any accessible ad account
Meta Lead Ads to Brevo (Make.com)	Scoped	Needs client to authorise a Facebook connection inside Make.com

Roadmap

Step	Action	Owner
1	DONE — security cleanup, privacy/compliance build-out, consent governance across GA4/Meta/Clarity, SEO skill plus 6 blog drafts, School Fees Loans page and form live.	Done
2	Review and publish (or edit) the six drafted blog posts.	You
3	Link the Zibuko Capital Facebook Page to an accessible ad account so the School Fees Loans Meta campaign can be built.	You
4	Authorise a Facebook connection inside Make.com so the Meta Lead Ads to Brevo relay can be built.	You
5	Accept Meta's Lead Gen Terms of Service on the ad account once campaign setup resumes.	You
6	Spot-check that Clarity's session recordings are masking loan-form fields as expected now that Strict mode is confirmed live.	You
7	Continue logging each further task in this project's activity log.	Both, ongoing

Reference

Website: zibuko.com

Privacy Policy: zibuko.com/privacy-policy/

School Fees Loans page: zibuko.com/school-fees-loans/

School Fees Loan Application form: Contact Form 7, id 4828e51

Microsoft Clarity project: uaz7w7mj01 (ZIBUKO)

Google Tag Manager container: GTM-K8KWLSMZ

Cookie consent plugin: CookieYes (cookie-law-info)

SEO / AEO / GEO skill: seo-aeo-geo-strategist

Privacy compliance skill: privacy-compliance-audit

Landing Page Specialist prompt: [Landing_Page_Specialist_Designer_Optimizer_Prompt.md](#)

This document will be updated as further tasks are completed — see [data/activity-log.md](#) for the running log of individual entries going forward.